

# Use of biopesticide

Good planning is essential for the safe and effective application of various biopesticides in the garden and greenhouses.

The following is a step-by-step checklist:

## ***Planning the application of a biopesticide***

- First of all, always check with your organic certifier if they approve the product. Make sure that the product is approved for the intended use: the type of crop, the target disease or pest, and the type of location where the spraying will take place (field or greenhouse).
- Check the level of health impact and environmental impact of the biopesticide in order to make an informed decision on the choice of product. Between two options, choose the product with the least negative impact on health and the environment.
- Check the "re-entry interval "(REI) and respect it. Don't forget to notify your team members and other potential stakeholders (e.g., agronomist) of the location of the spray and the re-entry interval.
- Establish the optimal time for application (morning, day or evening).
- For field spraying, choose a windless day to decrease the risk of drift.
- Determine the area to be treated (calculate in number of beds).
- Read the product label completely.
- Calculate the rate of pesticide to be used according to the area to be treated (the recommended rate is indicated on each product label). Follow the recommended rates at all times.

## ***Preparing to apply a biopesticide***

- Always wear protective goggles and gloves during all stages of preparation: measuring, mixing and cleaning.

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- Weigh or measure the amount of pesticide required for an accurate treatment. NEVER make the mistake of believing that a higher dosage will give a better result. This can create safety problems or even endanger the survival of the plants.
  - Once the correct amount of biopesticide has been measured, store the containers in your biopesticide cabinet. Carefully record the treatment in a logbook.
  - Fill the tank of your sprayer with 1/3 of the amount of water intended for the treatment.
  - Add the biopesticide to the tank, stir to dissolve/dilute it well.
  - Add enough water to get the required amount of solution in the tank, then close.
  - At the time of application: Wear goggles and gloves, a particle mask, Tyvek coveralls and waterproof boots.

### ***Applying a biopesticide***

- Always start your application by walking to the end of the row to be treated and spray backwards. This avoids advancing into the suspended biopesticide particles.
- When applying in the field, avoid spraying puddles, as pollinators drink from them.
- For a backpack sprayer: at regular intervals, tilt the spray tank to ensure proper dilution of the pesticide.
- After spraying, rinse the tank 3 times while allowing water to circulate through the hose. Spray until the nozzle is well drained.
- Store the sprayer and proceed to triple rinse the protective equipment before storing it in a closed area.
- Wash hands thoroughly.

### ***After applying the biopesticide***

- Scrupulously respect the "preharvest interval" (PHI) of a sprayed crop. Anticipate that crops sprayed with a biopesticide will not be available for harvest for some time (varies by biopesticide type).
- Respect the time intervals before respraying a crop. One of the benefits of doing this is to reduce the risk of pests developing resistance to the biopesticide.
- Record changes, observations and comments in the logbook.